Margin

A manuscript on a desk. Content reads like a book; the editor's notes live in the margin.

Second iteration
Margin rules, states, dark mode, five screens, and copy rules.

The page

Everything a person writes or reads is a page: one column, Literata, 1.6 leading.

The margin

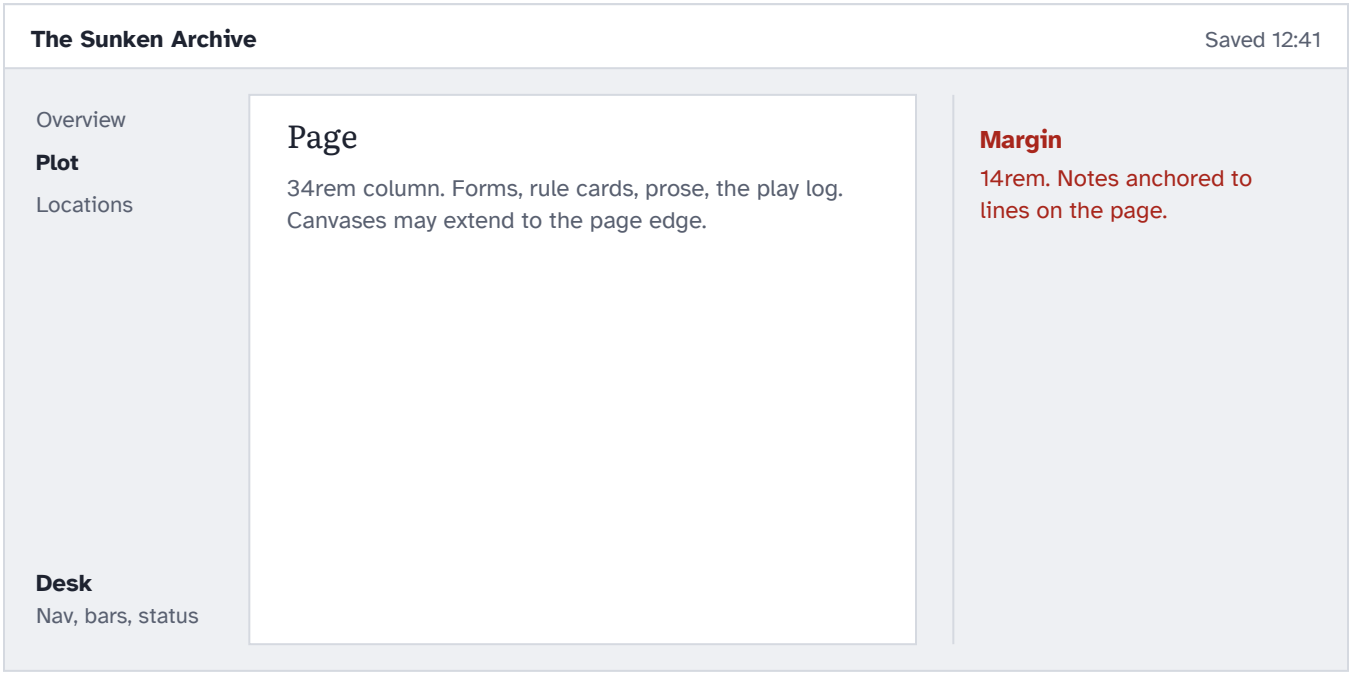
A fixed column to the right of the page. Only notes go there: problems, hints, and the playtest trace.

The desk

Navigation, status, and controls the software owns. Set in Atkinson Hyperlegible, kept quiet.

Layout: page, margin, desk

Three zones with fixed jobs. The page holds content, the margin holds notes about that content, and the desk holds the software.



Widths

Section nav	12rem (192 px) Desk; collapses to a menu below 1024 px
Page	34rem (544 px) prose and forms; up to 48rem (768 px) for canvases Centred in the space left of the margin
Gutter	2rem (32 px) Between page and margin; leader lines cross it
Margin	14rem (224 px) Collapses below 1280 px; see Responsive
Top bar	48 px high Product, sections, notifications, account

Responsive

1280 px and wider	Nav, page, margin side by side.
1024 to 1279 px	The margin becomes a drawer opened from the problem count; anchored notes show as a mark at the line.
Below 1024 px	Notes render inline under their field. Nav becomes a menu. The page fills the width with 16 px insets.

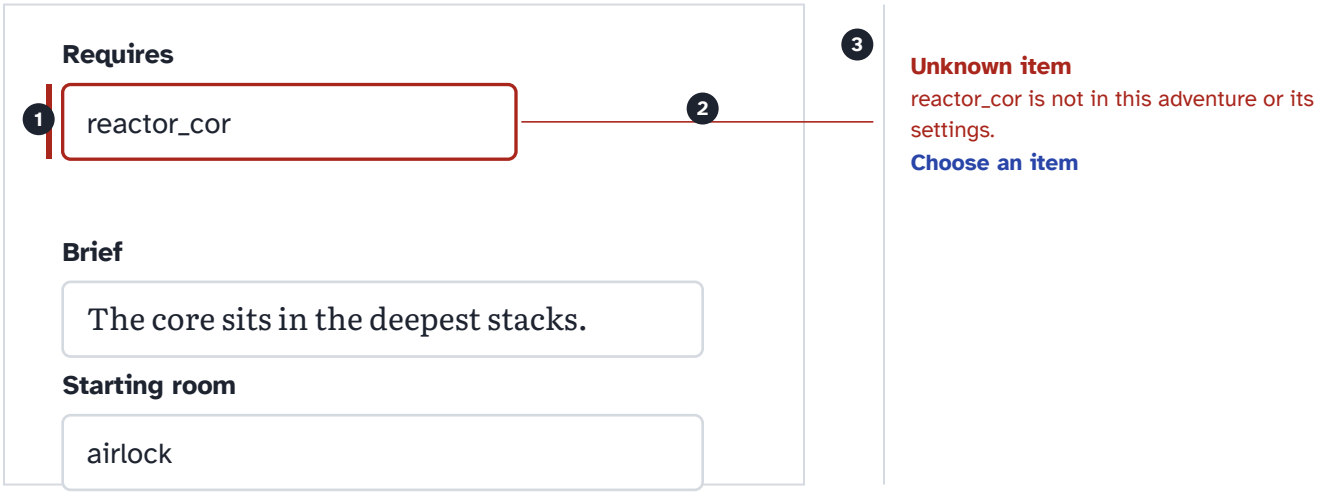
The margin

Notes are the editor's pencil: short, specific, and placed beside the line they concern. The page text is never covered, dimmed, or moved by a note.

Kinds

●	**Error**	Correction	Blocks publishing. Anchor bar and leader in Correction.
●	**Warning**	Query	Publishing allowed. Unused flags, unreachable topics.
●	**Hint**	Graphite	Guidance while filling a form. Disappears once the field is valid.
●	**Trace**	Fountain ink	Playtest only. Which triggers matched, which conditions failed.

Anatomy



1	**Anchor**	2 px bar on the left edge of the field or card, in the note's colour.
2	**Leader**	0.5 px line from the field's right edge to the margin rule, at the field's centre line.
3	**Note**	Bold title naming the problem, one-sentence body, optional action link. 14rem wide.

Placement

- A note's title aligns with its anchor's top edge.
- When notes would overlap, later notes move down with 8 px between them, and the leader bends once to reach them.
- When a note would sit more than 120 px below its anchor, the overflow collapses into a single line: 3 more problems below. Selecting it scrolls the page.
- Notes keep their order with the page as it scrolls. They never float or follow the pointer.
- Selecting a note focuses its field. Selecting a field highlights its note.
- Notes about records in another section have no anchor on this page. They collect at the top of the margin with a link to the record.

Controls and states

Every control has the same five states. Focus is always visible: a 2 px Fountain ink ring, 2 px out.

Buttons

	Rest	Hover	Focus	Disabled	Loading
Primary	Publish	Publish	Publish	Publish	Publishing
Secondary	Export	Export	Export	Export	
Quiet	Add trigger	Add trigger	Add trigger	Add trigger	
Danger	Delete	Delete	Delete	Delete	

Loading replaces the label with the action in progress (Publishing) and keeps the width. Danger actions ask for confirmation in a dialog that repeats the object's name.

Fields

Rest

airlock

Focus

airl

Error

reactor_cor

Disabled

quest

Selection controls

- [x] Only once
- [ ] Automatically resume

- ( ) Fighter
- (•) Spy

Menus, dialogs, toasts

Archivist Oyelaran
Rook's contact
Warden Ilse
New NPC

Delete the arc Find the core?

Its 4 triggers and 2 stages are removed from the draft. Published versions are unchanged.

Keep arc | Delete arc

Published 1.2.0

Toasts confirm with the action's own verb, last 5 s, and never carry errors.

Words

Interface text follows the same rules as the documentation: plain verbs, sentence case, one job per element.

Name actions by what happens

- ● Publish, Invite player, Add trigger, Start instance
- ● Submit, OK, Go, Continue

Keep an action's name through the flow

- ● Publish, then Publishing, then Published version 1.2.0
- ● Publish, then Saving, then Success

Errors say what and how

- ● Unknown item. Choose an item from this adventure or its settings.
- ● Oops, something went wrong

Empty states invite the next step

- ● No characters yet. Create a character to join a game.
- ● Nothing to see here

Use the reader's words

- ● Players, game, session, room
- ● Instance participants, entities, nodes

Label, do not decorate

- ● Starting room
- ● STARTING ROOM, Starting Room:

Two voices

The software speaks in Atkinson Hyperlegible: labels, buttons, notes, and status. The story speaks in Literata: narration, room text, NPC briefs, and anything the author wrote. Player input in the log is Atkinson italic, so it reads as the player's words, not the narrator's.

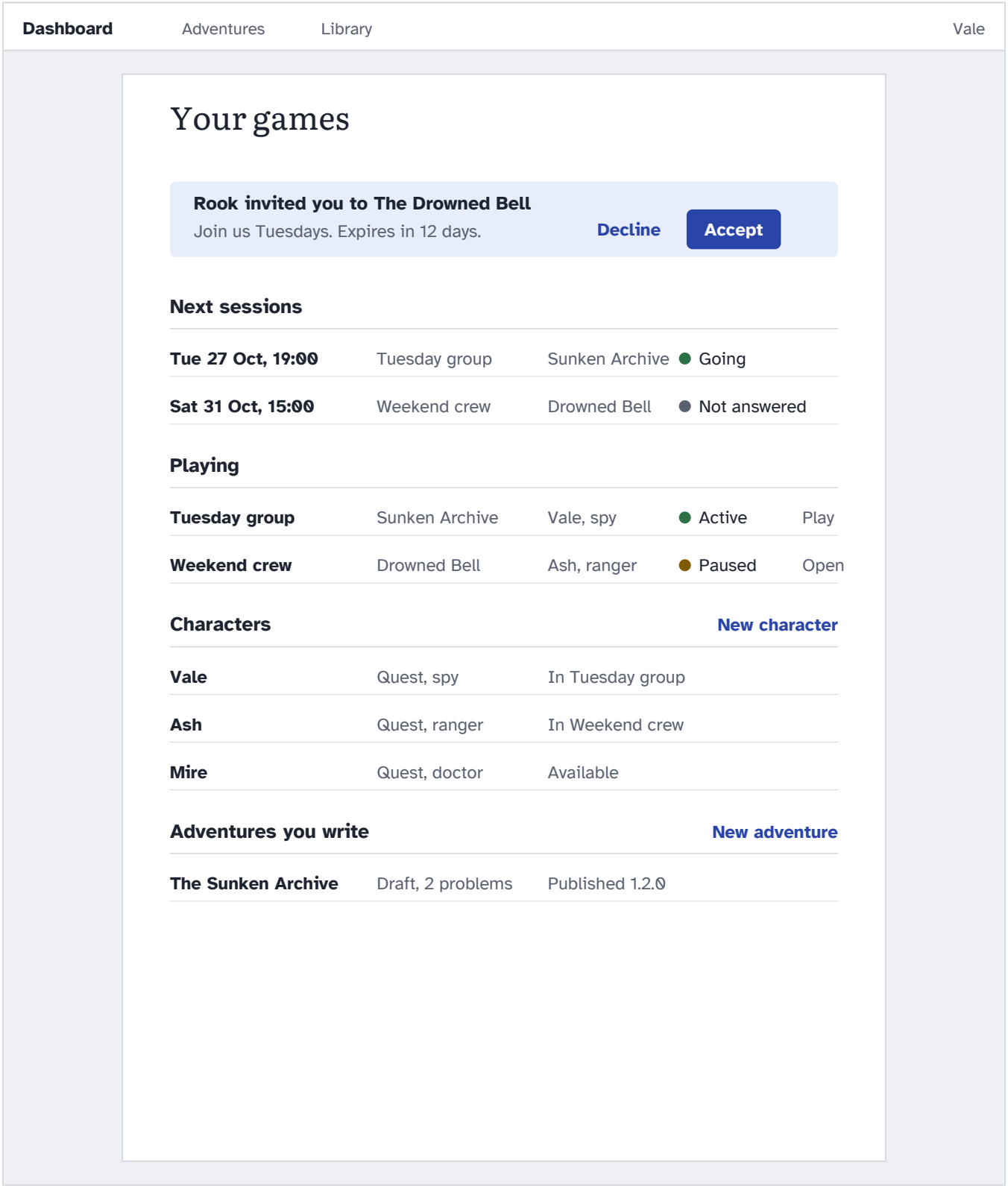
Narrator The panel wakes under Rook's keycard. Somewhere behind the bulkhead, a lift begins to climb.

Player *Rook: check the control panel*

Software Rolled 8, tough choice

Screen: dashboard

Lists, not cards. The dashboard is a contents page: each line leads somewhere.



Screen: character creation

Step 2 of 2 for Quest. The form is a page; the margin counts what is left to choose.

New character Step 2 of 2

A Quest character

Name

Vale

Role

- ○ Fighter — A brave warrior.
- ○ Invoker — Calls on divine power.
- ◉ **Spy** — Works unseen.
- ○ Doctor — Heals and studies.

4 more roles

Abilities 4 of 6

- ☑ Disguise — 1 AP
- ☑ Listen — free
- ☑ Lockpick — free
- ☑ Smoke bomb — 2 AP
- ☐ Shadow step — 3 AP
- ☐ Cutpurse — 1 AP

What do you look like?

Tall, ink on my fingers, a coat two sizes too large.

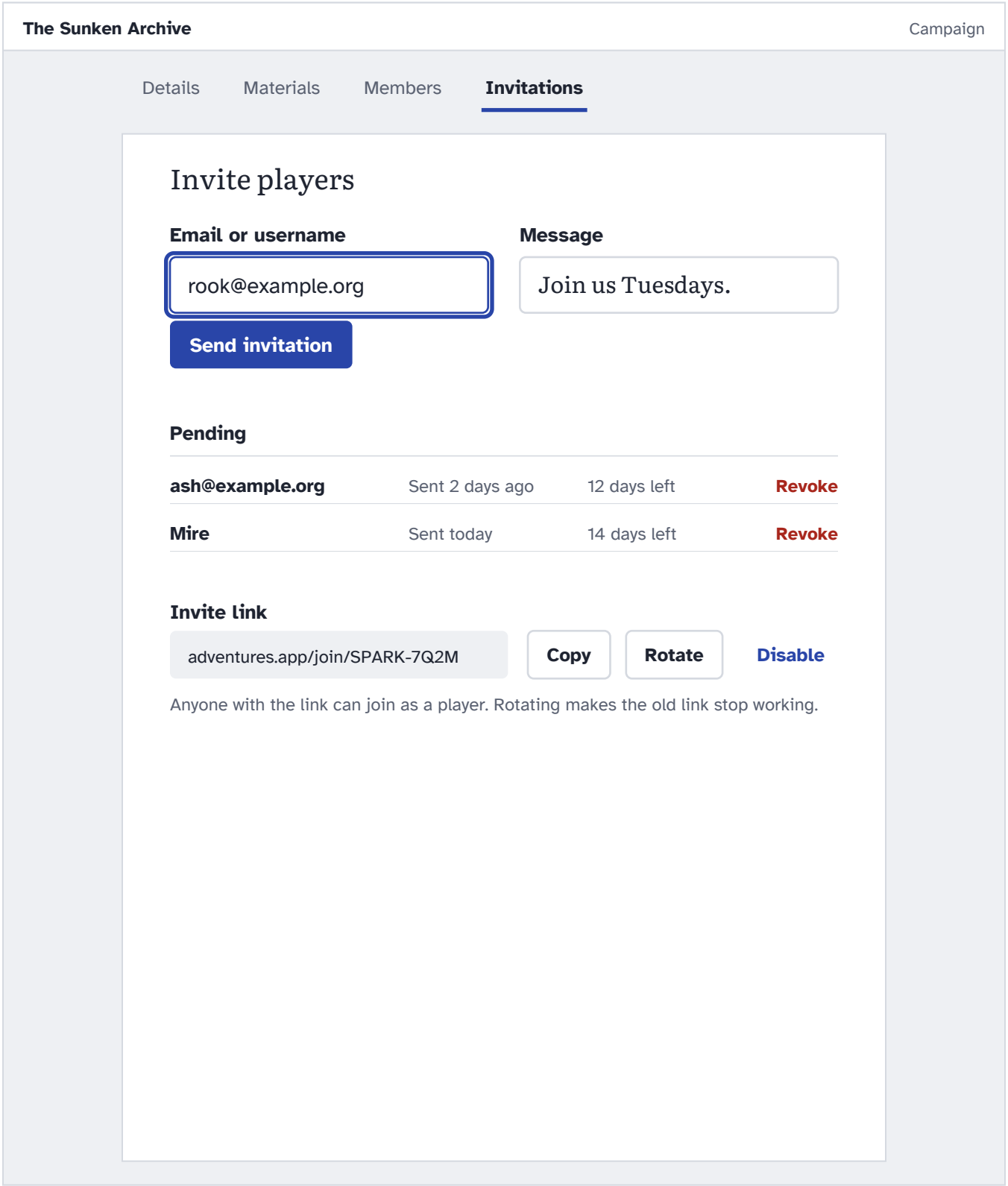
Create character Back

Choose 2 more abilities
Quest characters start with 6. You learn more after each session.

Create is unavailable
Finish choosing abilities first.

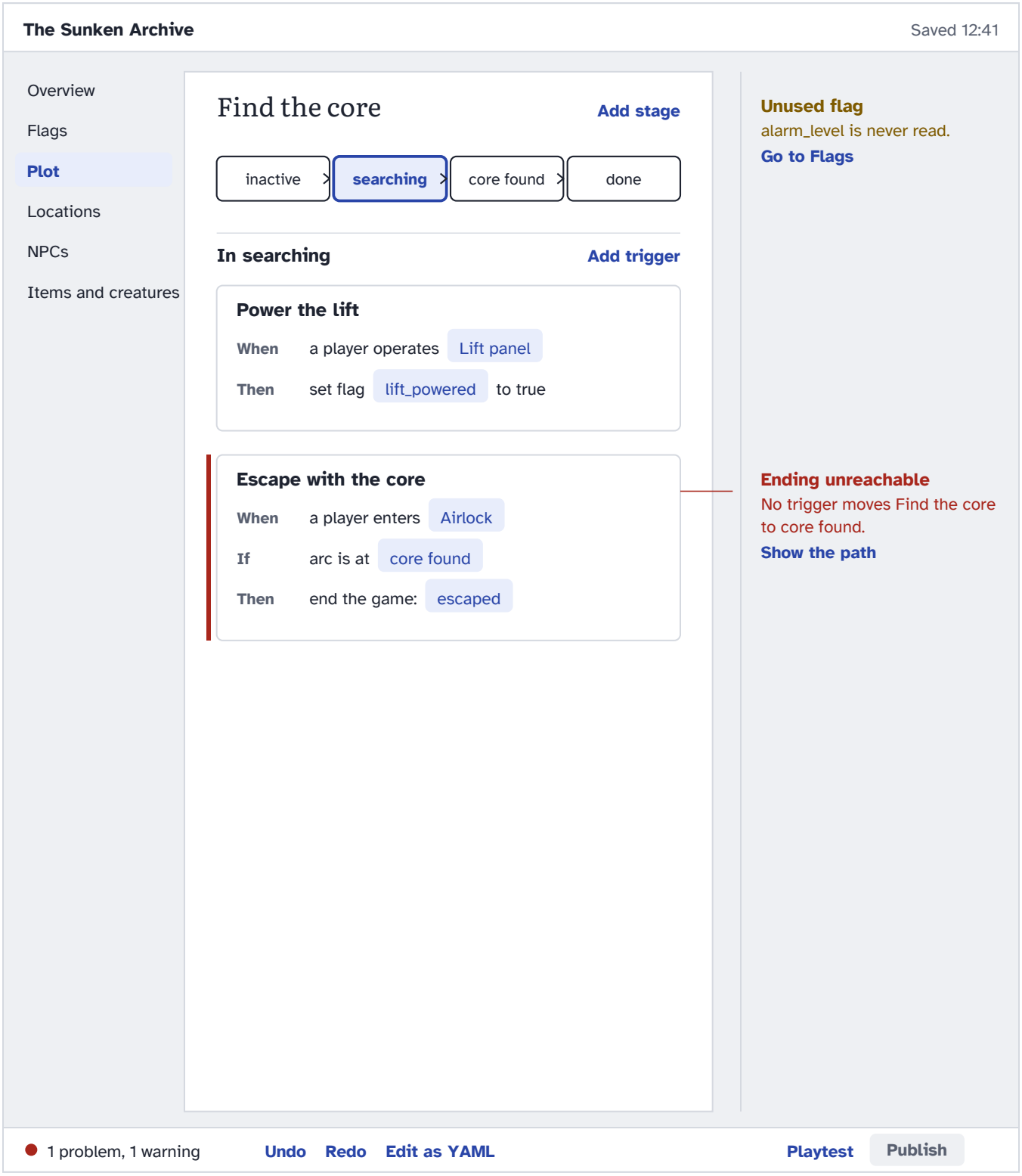
Screen: campaign editor, invitations

Tabs sit on the desk above the page. The invitation list is a table on the page.



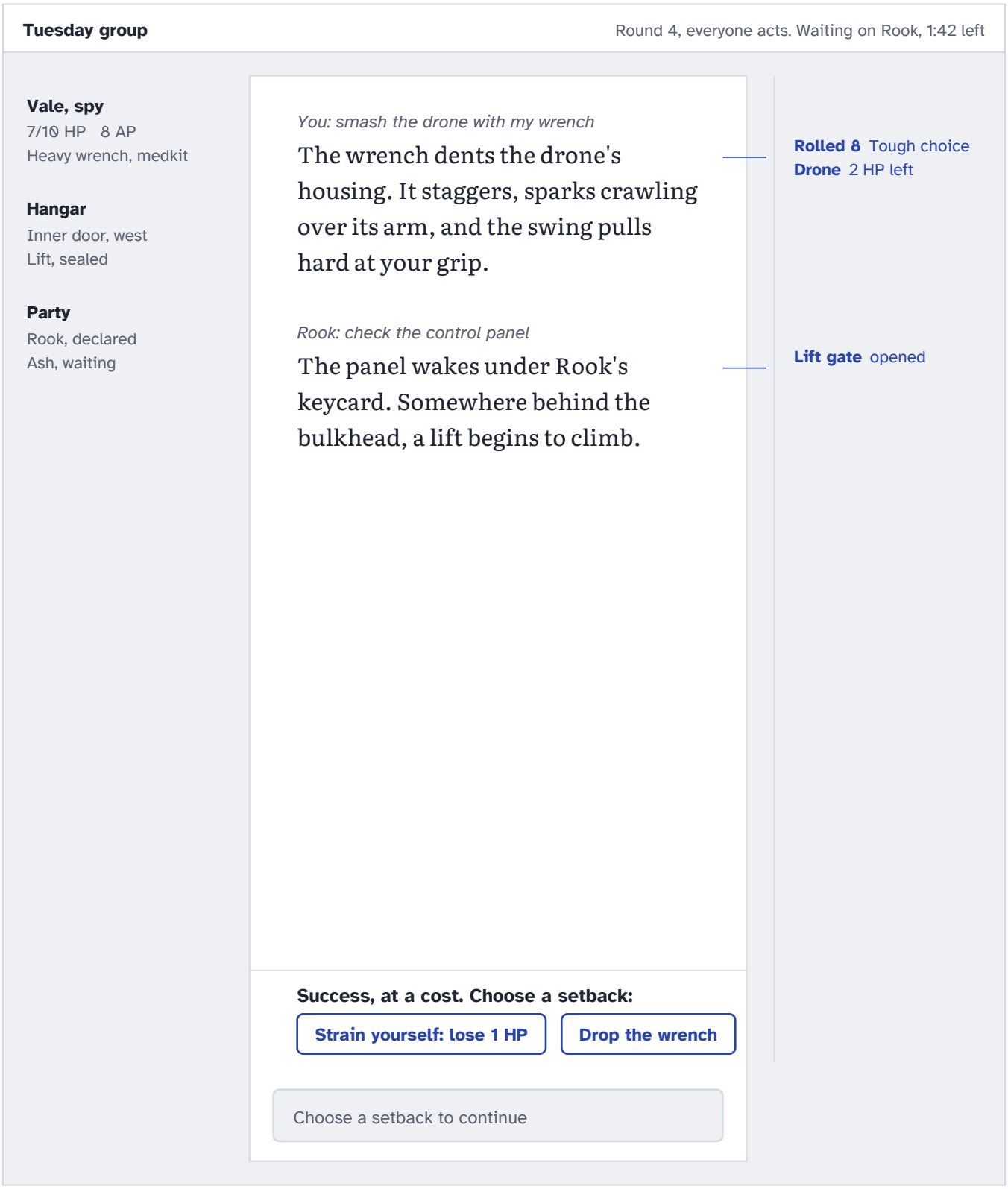
Screen: adventure editor

Plot section. The selected stage's triggers follow the graph on the page; problems sit in the margin beside the card they concern.



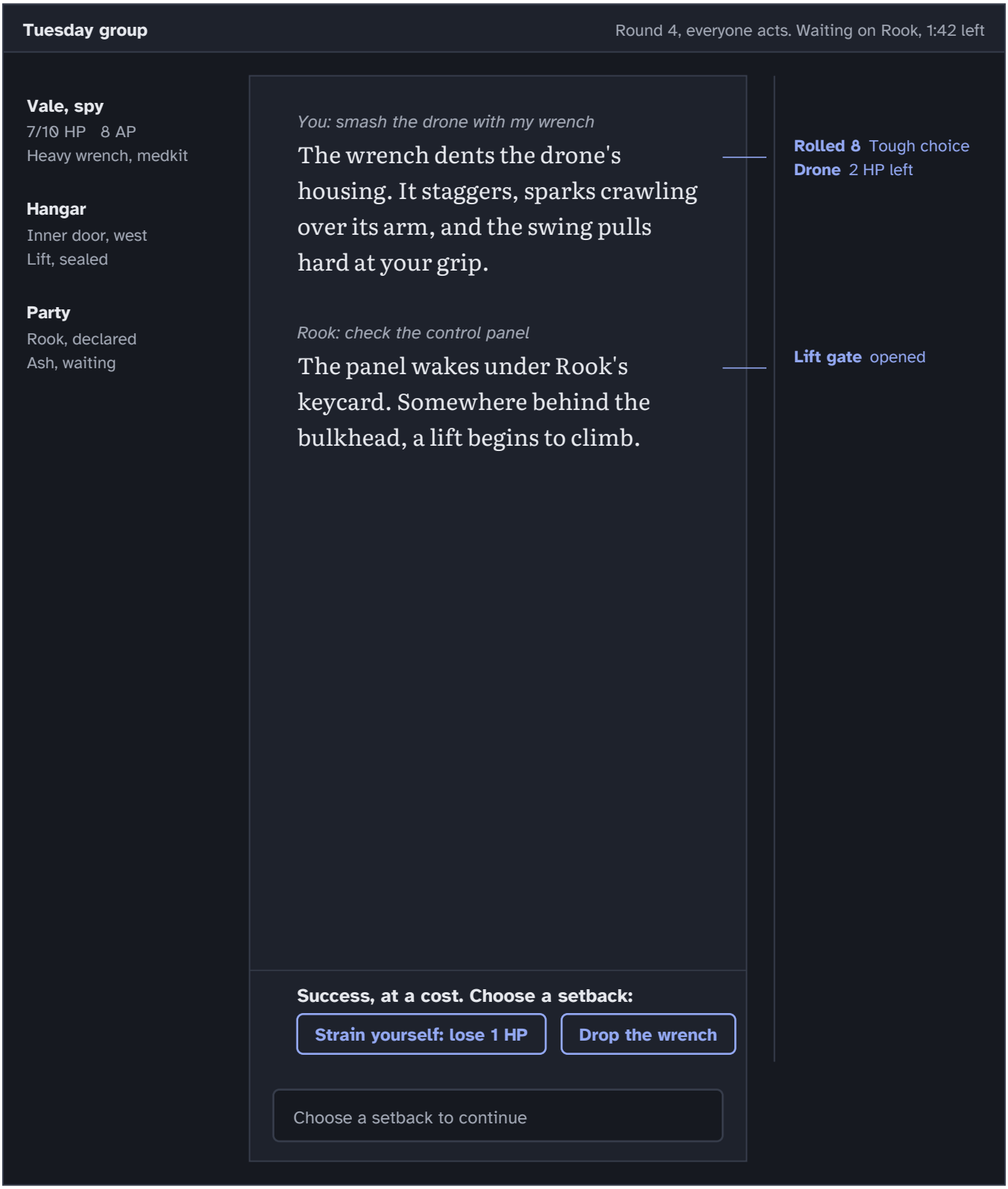
Screen: play

The log is the page. The margin carries the trace of rolls. Character, room, and party sit on the desk to the left.



Screen: play, at night

Dark mode keeps the same structure: the page becomes the lit sheet on a darker desk.



Tokens

Light and dark values for the same names. The theme switches with prefers-color-scheme and a manual setting in Settings.

Token	Light	Dark	Contrast on page, light / dark
page	#FFFFFF	#1E222C	surface
desk	#EEF0F3	#161920	surface
ink	#1E2330	#E7E9EE	15.7:1 / 13.1:1
muted	#596070	#A3A9B6	6.3:1 / 6.7:1
rule	#D5D9E0	#363C4A	surface
accent	#2945A8	#93A8F2	8.4:1 / 6.9:1
accent-soft	#E8EDFB	#27315A	surface
danger	#A8261C	#F2958B	7.1:1 / 7.2:1
danger-soft	#FBECEA	#3A2426	surface
success	#2C7046	#82CB9F	6.0:1 / 8.3:1
warning	#7E5A00	#E5C36F	6.3:1 / 9.4:1

```
@theme {
  --color-page: #FFFFFF;  /* every token as above */
  --font-prose: "Literata", Georgia, serif;
  --font-ui: "Atkinson Hyperlegible", system-ui, sans-serif;
  --radius-control: 3px;  --spacing: 4px;
  --width-page: 34rem;  --width-margin: 14rem;  --width-nav: 12rem;
}
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  :root:not([data-theme=light]) { --color-page: #1E222C;  /* … */ }
}
```

Icons

Lucide (ISC license, lucide-react) at 16 px with a 1.5 px stroke, in Ink or Graphite. Icons accompany labels; an icon alone is used only for undo, redo, close, and the menu, each with an accessible name.